



EPITOME

*“The world will ask
you who you are, and
if you don’t know, the
world will tell you.”*

Dr CG Jung

ARCHETYPE FRAMEWORK RESULTS

LAURA TAITZ

*“All the most powerful ideas in
history go back to archetypes.”*

Dr CG Jung.

OVERVIEW OF ARCHETYPES AND LEADERSHIP

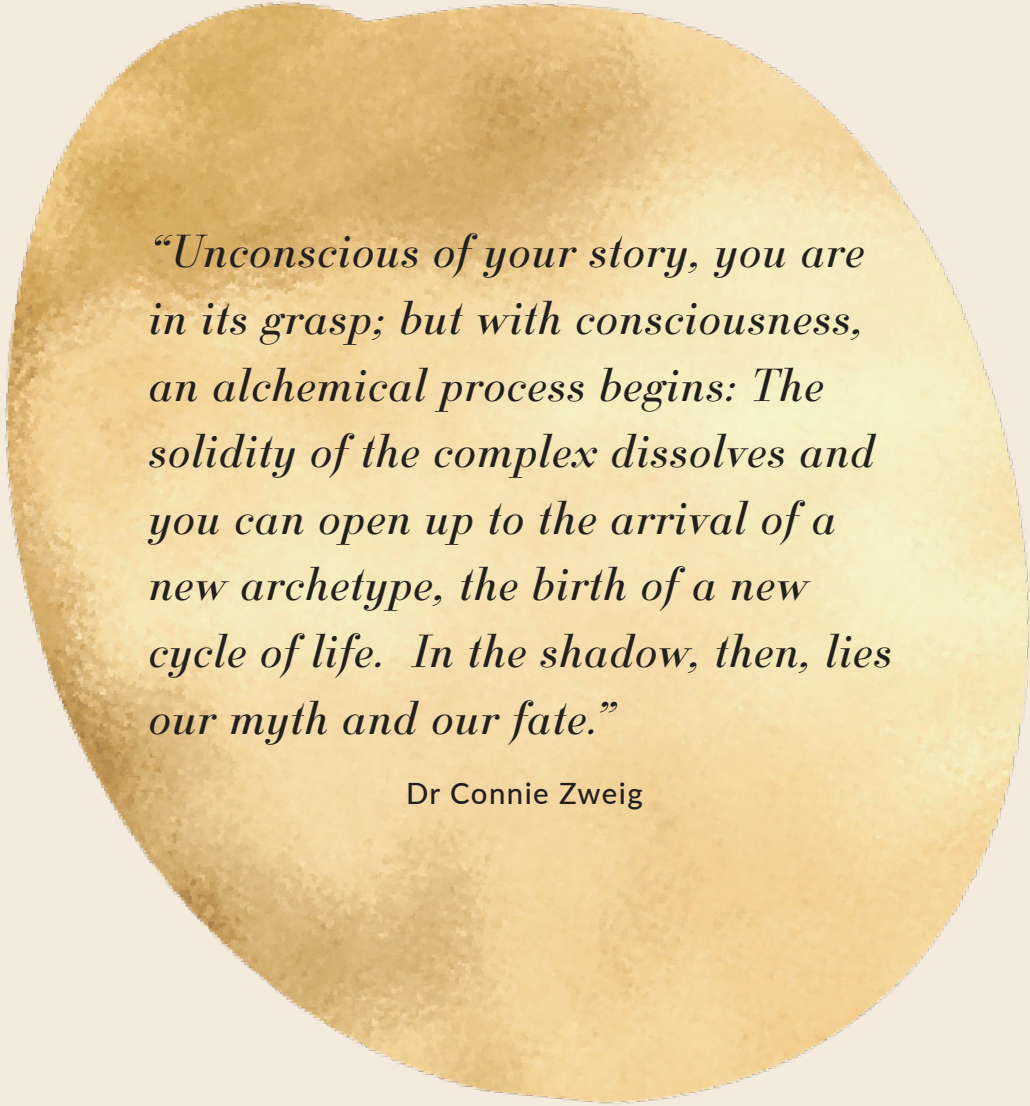
Archetypes are universal, recurring patterns of behavior that resonate deeply within human psychology. Originating from the work of the 20th century Swiss psychiatrist, C.G. Jung, these archetypes represent fundamental human motifs that cross cultures, gender, age and time periods.

In the context of leadership development, understanding archetypes can provide powerful insights into how individuals lead, their communication preferences, the ways they interact with peers and inspire others.

Archetypes embody specific strengths, abilities, and potential weaknesses or blind spots that create our individual leadership styles.

They are broad and universal, but each person expresses them in a unique and specific manner. Storytelling is one of the critical skills that leaders need and understanding how our archetypal profile supports this helps amplify this capability.

Archetypes are flexible and contextual. By understanding the depth and richness of our archetypes, it affords the leader the ability to embody different archetypes depending on situation, context and goals. They provide a path to integrate different leadership styles and amplify adaptive leadership capabilities.



“Unconscious of your story, you are in its grasp; but with consciousness, an alchemical process begins: The solidity of the complex dissolves and you can open up to the arrival of a new archetype, the birth of a new cycle of life. In the shadow, then, lies our myth and our fate.”

Dr Connie Zweig

THE EPITOME ARCHETYPE FRAMEWORK

Building on the rich history of archetypes, the Epitome Archetype Framework (EAF) leverages four new, simple, concise, and yet profound, female leadership archetypes (Sovereign, Empress, Consort, and Seductress)¹ as the catalyst to explore the confidence, self-awareness, and resilience that will enable leaders to flourish and advance. The EAF archetypes include the Sovereign, the Consort, the Empress and the Seductress with each leader having a distinctive combination of the four. This unique archetypal constellation provides a lens into the individual's leadership style.

As part of the EAF, the assessment provides the catalyst for reflection on leadership identity, areas for amplification or exploration, and an appreciation of the potential gifts of all four archetypes. EAF has four distinct archetypes, each bearing qualities and gifts, and a potential set of shortcomings and challenges. These observations afford the leader an opportunity to reflect, refine and refresh their style, behaviour, communication, and importantly their leadership adaptability.

The Framework is based on a three-year research project under the auspices of Deakin University's Business School, which explored the changing leadership narratives of emerging and seasoned women in Australia and the USA. Merle Singer was a funded researcher with the Center for Applications of Psychological Type and included archetype as the basis of the in-depth conversations with all the research participants.

This research, together with her decade-long leadership development business and a lengthy corporate career in Australia's first tech unicorn has led to the creation of the unique, simple and deeply layered Epitome Archetype Framework (EAF) for women in leadership. It allows the leader to explore ways and opportunities to refine and their leadership for the future with a language, signposts and clarity to refresh their potential.

¹ The new archetype framework is built-on a **three-year global research project** on female leaders under the auspices of Deakin University's Business School. The research explored the changing face of leadership styles and narratives in emerging women and senior women as they navigate a volatile, uncertain, complex and ambiguous world (VUCA) both in Australia and the USA.



EPITOME ARCHETYPE

Executive Overview

The Sovereign



As a **natural leader**, the Sovereign appreciates clarity of data, logical **argument** and **wisdom** in decision-making. A **calm, analytic**, clear leader with a **strong understanding of systems** and how best to operate within them are some of the qualities she possesses.

The Sovereign possess **personal power** and at her best she is an exceptional **mentor and sponsor** for those around her, appreciating the **importance of teams** in achieving vision and goals.

When this archetype is high, some of the **leadership challenges** that may be embodied include being seen by others as **aloof, intimidating, withering** and hard to get to know.



EPITOME ARCHETYPE

Executive Overview

The Consort



As a highly **networked and connected** leader, the Consort takes her true north from her senior leader and acts as the **power behind the throne**. She appreciates the importance of well-oiled systems and strong teams to achieve exceptional results.

The Consort’s power is not her own, but rather **reflected power** gained from her leader, and the strong engagement she has in the business is amplified by this **power-based relationship**.

When this archetype is high, some of the **leadership challenges** that may be displayed include **passive aggression, rejection sensitivity, and officiousness**. An unwavering support for her leader may not serve her personal ambitions, and she will need to recraft this relationship to a more equal one to activate her own **leadership power**.



EPITOME ARCHETYPE

Executive Overview

The Empress



A passionate and creative leader, the Empress takes an instinctual response to data and ensures her decision-making is a mix of **rigor and innate understanding**.

The Empress is a **natural in teams, possessing personal power**, which is amplified dramatically through the teams she works with. She takes pride in mastery of **understanding individual and team dynamic**.

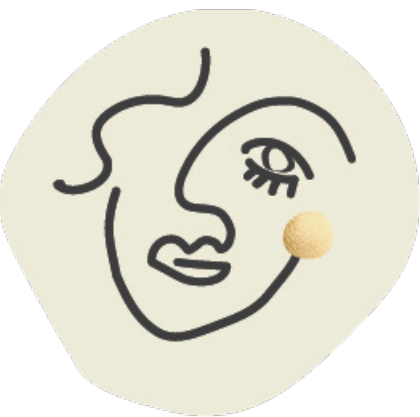
When this archetype is high, some of the **leadership challenges** that may be embodied include being seen by others as **chaotic** under pressure, **emotionally leaky and cliquish**.



EPITOME ARCHETYPE

Executive Overview

The Seductress



A driven and ambitious leader, the Seductress has a **presence** and a **magnetism** that she brings to her leadership style. She will incorporate **data, instinct and clarity** to drive her agenda.

The Seductress not only has **strong personal power**, she intuitively understands where the **power base** is in the organization and will **leverage** these to get things happening.

When this archetype is high, some of the **leadership challenges** that may be displayed include being seen by others as **self-absorbed, overly ambitious, ruthless** and dismissive.

EPITOME ARCHETYPES BY CRITERIA

You tend to lead with the **EMPRESS**.

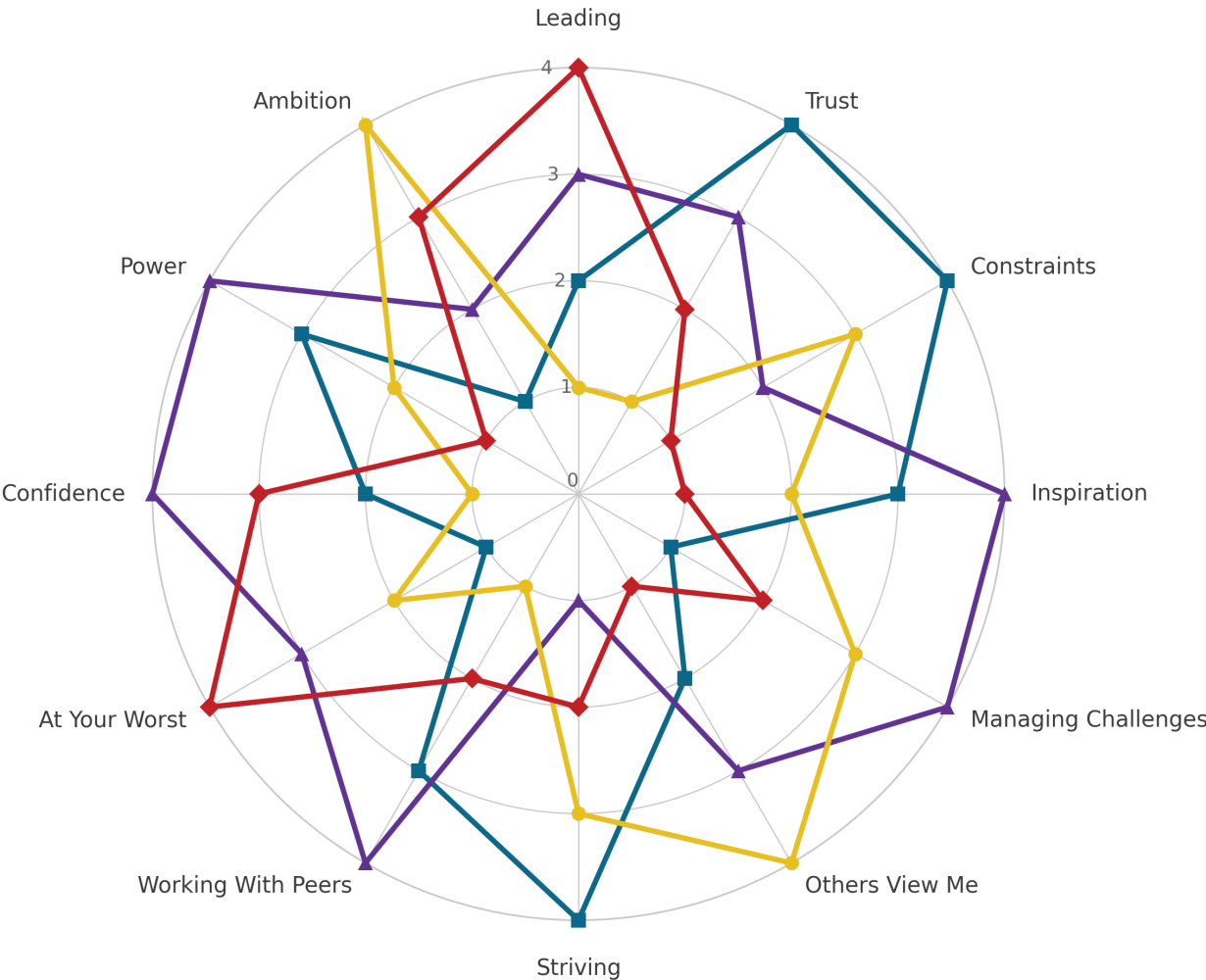
The diagram below is the analysis of the assessment you completed.

The legend outlines the colors representing each archetype -



Each assessment question represents a leadership dimension with four statements reflecting each of the four archetypes.

These represent your individual results on each criteria and show how the four archetypes were selected. The outer ring represents highest and the inner ring the lowest.



THE TWELVE EPITOME ARCHETYPE ASSESSMENT QUESTIONS

To assist in understanding the leadership criteria identified by the EAF assessment, below are the 12 questions you responded to when you completed the assessment. Each question had four statements and you ranked each statement from “fully describes me” to “does not describe me at all”.

Leading - What do you draw on to lead your team to deliver the optimum results?

Trust – What do you most trust when making decisions?

Constraints – What constrains you in work situations?

Inspiration – What inspires you in a senior leader?

Managing Challenges – How do you deal with challenges and setbacks?

Others View Me – How do work colleagues describe you?

Striving – What do you strive for in your role?

Working With Peers – How do you behave when working with your peers?

At Your Worst – How would you describe yourself when you are at your worst (under pressure/ bored/unhappy)?

Confidence – What gives you confidence when acting in a leadership role?

Power – How do you behave when working with your peers?

Ambition – How would you describe your relationship with ambition?



EPITOME

RESOURCES

CG Jung (1999) "Man and his Symbols"

Connie Zweig, Steven Wolf (2009).
"Romancing the Shadow: A Guide to
Soul Work for a Vital, Authentic Life"

Carol Pearson (2021) "What stories are you
living?"

Mary Dian Molton, Lucy Anne Sikes (2011)
Four Eternal Women: Toni Wolff Revisited

contact | merle@epitome-leadership.com